

Westbrook University

Office of Academic Affairs

Policy No: ACAD-GRD-003

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Revision: 1.0

Grade Change Request Guidelines

1. Overview

A grade change request is a formal mechanism through which a course instructor may correct or amend a final grade that has been officially recorded. This document outlines who may initiate a grade change, the permissible grounds, procedural steps, and applicable timelines.

2. Who May Initiate a Grade Change

Only the instructor of record for a course may initiate a grade change request. Students may not directly request a grade change; however, students may prompt an instructor to review a grade by submitting a grade dispute per the Undergraduate Grading Policy (ACAD-GRD-001, Section 6).

In cases where the original instructor is unavailable (e.g., has left the university), the Department Chair may initiate the change after a review of the course records.

3. Permissible Grounds for Grade Change

- Clerical or computational error by the instructor
- Grading a student's work against incorrect criteria
- Completion of an Incomplete (I) grade within the approved timeframe
- Resolution of an academic integrity investigation (grade may increase or decrease)
- Court order or administrative directive

4. Timeline

Grade changes must be submitted within 60 calendar days of the end of the semester in which the course was offered. Changes requested after 60 days but within one academic year require Department Chair countersignature. Changes requested after one full academic year require countersignature from both the Department Chair and the Dean of Academic Affairs.

No grade changes are permitted more than three academic years after the original grade was recorded, except by extraordinary petition to the Provost.

5. Procedure

The instructor submits the Grade Change Request Form (Form REG-04) via the Faculty Portal. The form requires the original grade, the proposed new grade, and a written justification. The Registrar reviews the submission for completeness and forwards it to the appropriate approving authority based on timeline. Approved changes are reflected in the academic record within 3 business days.

